Introducing Bitcoin

- Created by Satoshi Nakamoto in 2008. It was published as a white paper 'Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System. This paper is available at https://bitcoin.org/en/bitcoin-paper'
- It is the most successful digital currency with billions of dollars invested.
- It has gained high number of users and investors, frequent new coverage, and growing number of Bitcoin-based startups and exchanges.
- Bitcoin futures are traded on the Chicago Mercantile Exchange (CME).
- Bitcoin can be defined in various ways; it's a protocol, a digital currency, and a platform.
- It is a combination of a P2P network, protocols, and software that facilitates the creation and usage of the digital currency.
- Nodes in this P2P network talk to each other using the Bitcoin protocol.

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- Various ideas and techniques from cryptography and distributed computing such as Merkle trees, hash functions, and digital signatures were used to design Bitcoin.
- BitGold, b-money, hashcash, and cryptographic time-stamping also provided some groundwork for the invention of Bitcoin.
- It is the first ever truly decentralized currency.
- Bitcoin solves several historically difficult problems related to electronic cash and distributed systems, including:
  - The Byzantine generals problem
  - Sybil attacks
  - The double-spending problem

Addresses generation procedure in Bitcoin

